

Elon Mosaic

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had blacklisted you from a major acquisition after you outbid him anonymously for a work he wanted. Tonight he planned to announce that your collecting practices were 'speculative theater' and block your appointment to the museum board.

Your other secret

You were the anonymous buyer in the auction incident everyone keeps referencing. You concealed your identity through Hugh to avoid a bidding war with Grant.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Keep Hugh from revealing your role in the auction.
3. Find out whether Artie supports your board candidacy.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant learned I had outbid him through a proxy. He threatened to expose me and wreck our deal. For once, someone had won an auction against him. He took it badly.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the collection scanning desk from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with the invoice identifying me as the anonymous bidder. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the collection scanning desk. I was dealing with the invoice identifying me as the anonymous bidder. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the collection scanning desk throughout the whole window. It also exposes the invoice identifying me as the anonymous bidder. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the collection scanning desk. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.